

Mobile operator assists banks after SIM-swap account takeover arrests

By Staff Reporter | 10 March 2019

SAPS Commercial Crimes Unit said it had referred a small cluster of suspected retail-banking fraud cases to industry investigators after names surfaced across separate applications and transaction reviews.

People familiar with the referral said Andile Sibanda, Ayanda Mokoena and Sipho Mkhize appeared in case notes shared with participating financial institutions. The concern centred on SIM swaps, password resets and rapid beneficiary changes, although investigators cautioned that banks would need to confirm the pattern against their own account and transaction records.

One investigator said the matter was useful because it did not look like a single obvious fraud event. "The signals sit across onboarding, device behaviour, payment velocity and customer contact history. No one table tells the full story," the person said.

The referral is expected to increase pressure on banks to improve internal fraud typologies, evidence packs and exception dashboards for operational teams.